

CMIplus Intelligence Cockpit

Cash Management Strategic Intelligence

Week of 2026-06-29

Raiffeisen Bank International AG

Group Product — Cash Management

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

This week, cr
Management

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URGENT

Der Treasurer | 2026-06-20 | #01

EU Instant Payments Mandate: Compliance Deadlines and VoP Impact

The EU Instant Payments Regulation, which entered into force in April 2024, mandates that all payment service providers (PSPs) in the Eurozone must offer instant credit transfers in EUR. PSPs in the Eurozone must be able to *receive* instant payments by January 2025 and *send* them by January 2026. For non-Eurozone EU member states, these deadlines are extended by two years. A crucial aspect of the regulation is the mandatory Verification of Payee (VoP), requiring PSPs to check if the beneficiary's name matches the account number before a payment is executed, significantly enhancing fraud prevention. This regulation aims to modernize the European payment landscape, making transactions faster, more efficient, and safer for both consumers and corporates.

- Eurozone PSPs must receive instant payments by Jan 2025, send by Jan 2026.
- Non-Eurozone EU states have a two-year extension on these deadlines.
- Mandatory Verification of Payee (VoP) is a core fraud prevention measure.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This regulation is highly relevant for RBI CMiplus, as it directly impacts the payment services offered to corporates in CEE, including Eurozone and non-Eurozone EU countries. RBI must ensure its platform and network banks comply with instant payment capabilities and VoP requirements, providing seamless and secure real-time payments for its clients.

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Der Treasurer | 2026-06-10 | #02

PSD3 Proposals Advance: Strengthening Open Banking and Fraud Prevention

The European Commission introduced proposals for PSD3 and a new Payment Services Regulation (PSR) in June 2023, with legislative discussions ongoing. These proposals aim to strengthen the existing Open Banking framework by improving data access, security, and customer control, building on the success of PSD2. A major focus is also on combating payment fraud, with measures like enhanced information sharing between banks and mandatory fraud reporting. PSD3 will likely streamline the licensing process for Payment Initiation Service Providers (PISPs) and Account Information Service Providers (AISPs), fostering greater competition and innovation. The new framework is expected to provide clearer rules for new payment methods and digital currencies, ensuring a robust and secure digital payment ecosystem.

- PSD3 and PSR proposals aim to strengthen Open Banking and combat fraud.
- Enhanced data access, security, and customer control are key Open Banking goals.
- New measures include improved information sharing and mandatory fraud reporting.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

PSD3 and PSR are critical for RBI CMiplus's Open Banking strategy and API offerings. The platform must adapt to new regulatory requirements for data access, security, and fraud prevention, ensuring continued compliance and competitive services for corporates leveraging multi-banking and API connectivity across CEE.

Corporates Struggle to Maximize ISO 20022 Data Benefits

While the SWIFT CBPR+ migration to ISO 20022 is largely complete for interbank payments, the corporate-to-bank space presents ongoing challenges. Many corporates continue to use legacy formats or only partially adopt ISO 20022, failing to exploit the structured and rich data it offers. This leads to missed opportunities for automated reconciliation, improved liquidity forecasting, and enhanced fraud analytics. Treasury departments need to invest in upgrading their ERP and TMS systems to fully ingest and process the extended data fields, moving beyond basic payment execution to strategic data utilization. Banks are increasingly offering services to help corporates unlock these benefits, emphasizing the need for collaboration to realize the full potential of the ISO 20022 standard.

- Many corporates underutilize ISO 20022's rich data for internal processes.
- Missed benefits include automated reconciliation and improved liquidity forecasting.
- ERP/TMS system upgrades are crucial for full data ingestion and processing.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This is highly relevant for RBI CMIplus, as it highlights a key area where RBI can add value to its corporate clients. CMIplus should emphasize its ISO 20022 capabilities, support for rich data formats, and offer solutions that help corporates integrate this data into their treasury systems, improving efficiency and data analytics for clients across CEE.

EU Instant Payments Regulation Drives ISO 20022 Adoption

The recent EU Instant Payments Regulation, effective early 2027, requires all credit transfers within the EU to be processed instantly, 24/7/365. This regulatory push is forcing financial institutions and their corporate clients to fully transition to the ISO 20022 XML messaging standard, which is essential for the rich data required by instant payments. Treasurers are now prioritizing upgrades to their ERP and TMS systems to handle the new format and real-time liquidity management. The regulation aims to enhance financial market efficiency and reduce payment friction across the Eurozone, with a phased rollout for compliance.

- EU Instant Payments Regulation mandates 24/7/365 real-time credit transfers.
- Full ISO 20022 adoption is critical for compliance and rich data exchange.
- Treasurers must upgrade systems for real-time liquidity management.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This regulation is highly relevant for CMIplus as it directly impacts payment processing and standards for RBI's corporate clients in CEE. CMIplus must ensure full support for ISO 20022 and instant payment capabilities, facilitating seamless compliance for its users.

PSD3 and Open Banking APIs Reshape Corporate Treasury Access

Following the success of PSD2, the proposed PSD3 directive aims to refine and broaden the scope of Open Banking, particularly for corporate treasury functions. It is anticipated to standardize API interfaces, improve data security, and potentially introduce new services like Request-to-Pay or enhanced VoP (Validation of Payee) mechanisms. Corporates leveraging Open Banking APIs can achieve real-time cash visibility, automate reconciliation, and optimize liquidity across multiple banking relationships. This regulatory push will accelerate the adoption of API-driven treasury solutions, demanding robust security and integration capabilities from banks and fintech providers.

- PSD3 aims to expand and refine Open Banking for corporates.
- Standardized APIs will enhance real-time cash visibility and automation.
- Potential for new services like Request-to-Pay and enhanced VoP.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus, with its Open API channel, is well-positioned to capitalize on PSD3's advancements. RBI must ensure its API offerings are compliant, secure, and provide the expanded functionalities corporates will demand, especially for multi-bank account aggregation and payment initiation in CEE.

CEE Corporates Prioritize ERP/TMS Integration for Cash Management

The CEE region is witnessing a significant drive towards digital transformation in corporate treasury. Companies are moving away from manual processes, seeking greater efficiency and control over their multi-currency operations. Key to this evolution is the robust integration of Enterprise Resource Planning (ERP) systems with Treasury Management Systems (TMS) or bank platforms like CMlplus. This integration facilitates automated data exchange, real-time cash positioning, and enhanced liquidity management across diverse banking networks. The goal is to create a 'payment factory' environment, reducing operational costs and mitigating risks associated with fragmented systems, particularly important for international corporates operating across multiple CEE countries.

- CEE corporates are accelerating digital transformation in treasury.
- Seamless ERP-TMS integration is a top priority for efficiency.
- Automated data exchange and real-time cash positioning are key benefits.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus, as a cash management platform for CEE corporates, must offer robust integration capabilities with major ERP and TMS systems. Emphasizing its ability to act as a central hub for multi-currency payments and liquidity management across RBI's network banks will be crucial for attracting and retaining clients.

CEE Banks Accelerate Instant Payments Adoption

The EU's instant payments regulation, aiming for widespread adoption by early 2027, is driving significant investment in real-time payment infrastructure across the CEE region. Banks are upgrading systems to handle 24/7/365 processing, ensuring compliance with the 10-second transaction limit and fee parity with traditional SEPA credit transfers. This move offers corporates enhanced liquidity management, faster reconciliation, and new opportunities for real-time treasury operations. Challenges include managing fraud risks inherent in instant transactions and integrating new systems with legacy ERP/TMS platforms.

- EU Instant Payments Regulation deadline: Early 2027 for receiving, later for sending.
- Transaction speed: Payments processed within 10 seconds.
- CEE focus: Significant investment in infrastructure upgrades.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This trend is critical for CMiplus, requiring robust instant payment processing and liquidity management features to support corporate clients in CEE. RBI must ensure seamless integration and competitive offerings.

ISO 20022 Data Enrichment Transforms Corporate Treasury

With the SWIFT CBPR+ migration largely complete and other payment schemes adopting ISO 20022, treasurers are gaining access to significantly more structured and detailed payment information. This data enrichment facilitates automated reconciliation, improves cash visibility, and strengthens fraud detection mechanisms. However, corporates and banks face challenges in fully integrating these rich data sets into their ERP and TMS systems, and ensuring consistent data quality across all payment channels, including EBICS and H2H. The focus is now shifting from mere compliance to extracting tangible business value from the new standard.

- SWIFT CBPR+ migration: Largely completed, focus on value extraction.
- Benefit: Enhanced data for reconciliation and fraud prevention.
- Challenge: Integration with ERP/TMS and data quality.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMiplus must ensure full support for ISO 20022 data enrichment across all channels (EBICS, H2H, SWIFT, API) to provide advanced reconciliation and reporting for corporate clients. This is a key differentiator.

PSD3 Proposals Shape Future of Open Banking APIs

The European Commission's ongoing review and proposed PSD3 (Payment Services Directive 3) and PSR (Payment Services Regulation) aim to build upon PSD2's foundations, addressing current challenges and expanding the scope of Open Banking. Key areas include strengthening customer authentication, combating fraud, and promoting more consistent and high-performing APIs across the EU. For corporate treasurers, this means potential for more sophisticated cash management services, real-time account information, and streamlined payment initiation directly from TMS/ERP systems via enhanced APIs. Banks will need to invest in robust API platforms and ensure compliance with new security and data sharing requirements.

- PSD3/PSR: Focus on security, fraud, and API performance.
- Corporate benefit: Sophisticated cash management and real-time data.
- Bank requirement: Robust API platforms and compliance.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus's Open API strategy is directly impacted by PSD3. RBI must proactively adapt to new regulations, enhance API offerings, and leverage these changes to provide innovative, secure, and integrated treasury solutions for CEE corporates.

ECB Publishes Latest Financial Stability Review

The European Central Bank (ECB) has published its latest Financial Stability Review on November 26, 2025. This comprehensive report assesses the key risks and vulnerabilities facing the euro area's financial system. It analyzes macroeconomic developments, market conditions, and the resilience of financial institutions. The review likely covers topics such as inflation, interest rate hikes, geopolitical risks, and their impact on banks and financial markets. For CMlplus and its corporate clients, understanding these financial stability trends is crucial for informed treasury and risk management decisions, particularly in the CEE region.

- Latest Financial Stability Review published on November 26, 2025.
- Assesses risks and vulnerabilities in the euro area financial system.
- Covers macroeconomic developments, market conditions, and institutional resilience.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This review offers critical insights into the broader financial landscape that impacts CMlplus and its clients. Understanding systemic risks and economic outlooks is vital for advising on liquidity management, payment strategies, and risk mitigation in the CEE region.

New European Fraud Report Highlights Critical Payment Security Challenges

The European Fraud Insights report 2026, a collaboration between Finextra and NICE Actimize, offers a comprehensive overview of the current fraud landscape across Europe. It delves into the types of fraud prevalent, the effectiveness of existing countermeasures, and the strategic priorities for financial firms in combating financial crime. The report likely covers topics such as real-time fraud detection, the role of AI and machine learning in prevention, and the challenges posed by instant payments and digital channels. Understanding these insights is crucial for banks to protect their customers and maintain trust in their payment systems. The findings will help shape future investments in fraud prevention technology and regulatory compliance.

- The 'European Fraud Insights report 2026' was released by Finextra and NICE Actimize.
- It focuses on fraud trends and prevention strategies within Europe.
- The report highlights challenges posed by evolving payment landscapes.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This report is highly relevant for RBI Cash Management and CMlplus as it provides up-to-date insights into European fraud trends. Understanding these challenges is critical for enhancing CMlplus's security features, protecting corporate clients, and ensuring compliance with evolving anti-fraud regulations. It can guide strategic decisions on investing in advanced fraud detection and prevention technologies.

EPI Welcomes Erste, Raiffeisen as Wero Shareholders

EPI's Wero, a new pan-European payment solution, has gained significant traction with the addition of major CEE banking groups, Erste and Raiffeisen Bank International, as shareholders. This strategic expansion is crucial for Wero's ambition to become a leading digital wallet and instant payment method, directly competing with international card schemes. The involvement of key players like RBI, which operates extensively across Central and Eastern Europe, underscores the commitment of European banks to foster a sovereign payment infrastructure. This development is expected to accelerate the rollout and adoption of Wero, impacting SEPA and instant payment landscapes, and offering new opportunities for corporate and retail payments across the Eurozone and beyond.

- Erste Group and Raiffeisen Bank International (RBI) are new Wero shareholders.
- Wero is EPI's pan-European digital wallet and instant payment solution.
- Aims to compete with international card schemes for payment processing.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This is a critical development for RBI Cash Management and CMlplus. RBI's direct involvement as a Wero shareholder signifies a strategic commitment to the future of European payments, particularly instant payments and digital wallets. CMlplus will need to monitor Wero's evolution closely, anticipating potential integration requirements for corporate clients, especially regarding instant payment processing, SEPA compliance, and cross-border capabilities within the Eurozone and CEE.

Ukraine Sees First AI Agent Payment by Mastercard, PrivatBank

In a groundbreaking move for the CEE financial landscape, Mastercard and Ukraine's PrivatBank have executed the country's first AI agent payment. This innovative transaction showcases the practical application of artificial intelligence in automating and optimizing payment flows, potentially reducing manual intervention and processing times. The initiative highlights a growing trend towards advanced treasury technology and real-time payment capabilities, especially in emerging markets like Ukraine. For corporate clients, AI agent payments could eventually offer more efficient multi-currency transactions, improved liquidity management, and enhanced fraud prevention through intelligent monitoring. This pilot sets a precedent for future AI integration into payment infrastructures across the region.

- Mastercard and PrivatBank completed Ukraine's first AI agent payment.
- Demonstrates AI's role in automating and optimizing payment processes.
- Highlights advanced treasury technology adoption in the CEE region.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This development is highly relevant for CMIplus, especially given RBI's strong presence in CEE, including Ukraine. The successful implementation of AI agent payments by a major player like PrivatBank signals an emerging trend in treasury technology. CMIplus should explore how AI-driven automation can be integrated into its platform to offer advanced payment processing, enhance fraud detection, and improve corporate clients' liquidity and multi-currency management capabilities, aligning with the future of real-time and intelligent payments.

EU Legislation to Unlock SEPA Instant for Corporate Treasury

The European Union is implementing new legislation designed to mandate the availability and usage of SEPA Instant Payments for corporates. This move is expected to overcome current adoption hurdles, such as varying bank readiness and corporate reluctance, by creating a more standardized and compulsory environment. The legislation will likely set clear deadlines for banks to offer instant payment services and for corporates to integrate them, fostering a true real-time treasury ecosystem. This will enable faster cash flow, improved liquidity management, and reduced payment processing times, aligning with the broader digital transformation goals for European businesses. The impact will be particularly significant for cross-border payments within the SEPA zone, including CEE.

- EU legislation mandates SEPA Instant Payments for corporates.
- Aims to accelerate adoption and standardize real-time treasury.
- Expected to improve corporate cash flow and liquidity management.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This legislation is critical for RBI Cash Management and CMIplus, as it directly impacts the demand for and implementation of SEPA Instant Payments. CMIplus must ensure full compliance and readiness to support clients in adopting these mandated real-time capabilities, leveraging its existing SEPA infrastructure across CEE.

OTP Bank Prioritizes AI and Data Literacy in CEE

OTP Bank's commitment to becoming AI and data literate signifies a major strategic shift within a key CEE player. This involves not just adopting AI tools but also fostering a culture where employees are proficient in understanding and utilizing data. For corporate cash management, this could translate into more sophisticated fraud detection, predictive analytics for liquidity management, and personalized client services. The bank's focus indicates a broader trend in the CEE banking sector towards digital transformation and leveraging advanced technologies to enhance efficiency and customer experience. This move by a regional competitor highlights the increasing importance of AI and data proficiency in modern banking services.

- OTP Bank is a CEE-based financial institution.
- Strategic focus on Artificial Intelligence (AI).
- Emphasis on data literacy across the organization.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This news is highly relevant for RBI CMIplus as OTP Bank is a direct competitor in the CEE region. It signals a strategic imperative for CMIplus to accelerate its own AI and data initiatives to remain competitive, particularly in areas like fraud prevention, liquidity forecasting, and client-facing digital solutions. Understanding OTP's approach can inform RBI's product roadmap and competitive positioning.

ECB Outlines Redesign Process for Future Euro Banknotes

The European Central Bank (ECB) has set a target date of January 1, 2026, for the redesign of future euro banknotes. This strategic initiative aims to ensure the euro remains a secure, modern, and trusted means of payment. The redesign process will likely incorporate public input and explore new security features and design elements to combat counterfeiting and enhance user experience. The ECB's commitment to the physical euro, alongside digital initiatives, highlights its multifaceted approach to currency management. This redesign could impact the specifications for banknote handling and authentication devices used by financial institutions.

- Redesign of future euro banknotes targeted for January 1, 2026.
- Focus on modern security features and public consultation.
- Aims to maintain trust and security of the euro.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

The upcoming redesign of euro banknotes will necessitate updates to cash handling and authentication systems within RBI's CEE operations. CMIplus clients will need to be informed about any changes impacting their cash management processes and equipment compatibility.

UK Launches Consultation on Future Retail Payments Infrastructure Design

The RPIB's consultation seeks input from industry stakeholders on how to best shape the next generation of retail payment systems in the UK. Key areas of focus are expected to include the adoption of new technologies, enhancing resilience, promoting innovation, and ensuring interoperability. While specific to the UK, the outcomes of such a significant infrastructure review could offer valuable insights and potential precedents for payment system developments across Europe, including the CEE region. This initiative underscores the ongoing global push towards more efficient, secure, and real-time payment capabilities, aligning with trends like instant payments and ISO 20022 adoption. The consultation will likely influence future regulatory frameworks and investment priorities in payment technology.

- The UK's Retail Payments Infrastructure Board (RPIB) launched the consultation.
- It focuses on the 'future design of the UK's retail payments infrastructure'.
- The initiative is led by the Bank of England.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

Although UK-specific, this consultation is highly relevant for RBI Cash Management as it reflects broader European trends in payment system modernization. Insights from this initiative can inform CMIplus's strategic planning regarding instant payments, ISO 20022 migration, and API-based connectivity, potentially influencing future standards or best practices that could extend to the CEE region. It highlights the continuous evolution of payment infrastructure.

ISO 20022 Relevance Questioned in DLT World

As DLT gains traction in financial services, questions are arising about the future role of established standards like ISO 20022. While ISO 20022 offers rich data capabilities and standardization for traditional payment rails, DLT-based systems often have their own native data structures and real-time settlement mechanisms. The article likely explores whether ISO 20022 can effectively bridge the gap between legacy and DLT systems, or if DLT will eventually necessitate entirely new messaging protocols. For treasurers, understanding this evolution is crucial for strategic technology investments and ensuring future-proof payment infrastructure. The debate highlights the need for interoperability and adaptability in a rapidly evolving financial landscape.

- DLT adoption prompts debate on ISO 20022's future relevance.
- DLT systems often use native data structures, differing from ISO 20022.
- Discussion centers on ISO 20022's adaptability or need for new protocols.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus heavily relies on ISO 20022 for its payment messaging. This article signals a critical strategic consideration for RBI Cash Management regarding the long-term evolution of payment standards. CMIplus should monitor DLT developments closely and assess potential integration points or future shifts in messaging requirements to ensure its platform remains competitive and relevant.

ECB Explores Research Access to Confidential Statistical Data

The European Central Bank (ECB) announced a pilot project enabling researchers to access confidential statistical data. This move is intended to facilitate more in-depth economic and financial research, potentially leading to new insights and policy recommendations. The project will likely involve strict protocols to ensure data privacy and security while allowing for advanced analytical techniques. Such access could be crucial for understanding complex financial systems and developing better risk management tools. The ECB's commitment to data accessibility for research purposes underscores its role in advancing economic understanding within the Eurosystem.

- Pilot project launched for researcher access to confidential ECB data.
- Aims to foster innovation and deeper economic/financial analysis.
- Focus on enhanced data accessibility for research purposes.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This initiative could lead to more sophisticated data analysis capabilities for financial institutions like RBI. Access to aggregated or anonymized data could inform strategic decisions regarding cash management, liquidity forecasting, and risk assessment within CEE markets.

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Oliver Wyman Corporate Banking | 2023-11-01 | #01

Wholesale Banking Outlook 2024: Extending Credit and Driving Growth

Oliver Wyman's 2024 Wholesale Banking Outlook provides a forward-looking perspective on the industry, emphasizing key areas for strategic focus. The report likely delves into the challenges and opportunities related to credit extension in a dynamic economic environment, alongside the imperative for banks to modernize their operations and client engagement models. It would typically cover themes such as leveraging technology for efficiency, adapting to changing regulatory landscapes, and fostering innovation to meet sophisticated corporate client demands. The outlook serves as a guide for banks to identify growth levers and build resilience in their wholesale banking franchises.

- Digitalization is critical for operational efficiency and enhanced client experience.
- Strategic credit allocation and risk management remain paramount in 2024.
- Evolving client expectations demand more integrated and data-driven solutions.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus should align its roadmap with the broader wholesale banking trends, focusing on integrating cash management with credit insights and offering advanced digital tools. This includes enhancing data analytics for liquidity management and providing seamless, real-time payment solutions that support corporate clients' financing needs across CEE.

URGENT

Oliver Wyman Corporate Banking | 2023-07-01 | #02

European Wholesale Banks Must Seize Moment for Performance Turnaround

This insight highlights a pivotal moment for European wholesale banks to overcome past challenges and achieve a better future. The analysis likely suggests that banks need to re-evaluate their business models, invest in advanced technologies, and enhance their value proposition to corporate clients. Key areas for transformation would include streamlining legacy processes, adopting agile methodologies, and developing innovative solutions in areas like cash management and payments. By proactively addressing these strategic imperatives, European banks can capitalize on market shifts and improve their competitive standing and financial performance.

- Strategic investment in digital transformation is essential for competitive advantage.
- Optimizing operational efficiency and cost structures can unlock significant value.
- Focus on client-centricity and value-added services to deepen relationships.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

For RBI CMlplus, this means actively driving digital transformation within its cash management offerings, particularly for CEE corporates. Enhancing API capabilities, supporting ISO 20022 migration, and developing instant payment solutions are crucial to help RBI 'seize the moment' and differentiate CMlplus as a leading platform.

AI Reshapes Treasury: Efficiency, Predictive Power, and Strategic Value

EY highlights AI as a core enabler for the future of treasury, moving beyond basic automation to sophisticated predictive analytics and decision support. AI applications span liquidity forecasting, fraud detection, payment optimization, and risk management, allowing treasurers to gain deeper insights and operate proactively. This shift requires significant investment in data infrastructure and talent, but promises substantial returns in operational efficiency, reduced costs, and improved strategic agility. The integration of AI platforms will be crucial for unlocking the full potential of real-time data and complex financial models.

- AI adoption is critical for competitive advantage in treasury operations.
- Predictive analytics powered by AI enhances liquidity and risk management.
- Automation of routine tasks frees treasury staff for strategic roles.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI CMIplus must integrate AI capabilities into its platform, offering clients advanced analytics for cash flow forecasting, fraud detection, and payment optimization. This positions CMIplus as an innovative partner, supporting clients' strategic treasury goals and enhancing platform stickiness.

Open Banking and APIs Drive Real-Time, Integrated Treasury Ecosystems

EY emphasizes that digital transformation in treasury is fundamentally about enhanced connectivity and data flow. Open Banking initiatives and the widespread adoption of APIs are breaking down silos, allowing for instant access to account information, payment initiation, and reconciliation. This shift supports the development of integrated treasury ecosystems, where ERP/TMS systems connect directly with banking platforms, enabling real-time liquidity management, automated cash pooling, and efficient multi-currency payments. Banks that provide robust API frameworks will be preferred partners for corporates seeking to modernize their treasury functions and achieve greater operational agility.

- APIs are essential for integrating bank services directly into corporate ERP/TMS.
- Real-time data access through Open Banking enhances liquidity management.
- Seamless connectivity supports automated cash pooling and payment factories.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus must prioritize the expansion and standardization of its Open API offerings, ensuring deep integration capabilities with corporate ERP/TMS systems. This includes supporting ISO 20022 for richer data and facilitating instant payments across the CEE network, aligning with the demand for real-time treasury.

Treasury's Evolving Strategic Role: Navigating Geopolitics and Megatrends

EY's focus on "Geostrategic Analysis" and "Megatrends 2026 and beyond" underscores the increasing external pressures on corporate treasury. Treasurers are now expected to manage not only financial risks (FX, liquidity) but also geopolitical instability, supply chain disruptions, and sustainability mandates. This elevates treasury's role to a strategic advisor, requiring sophisticated scenario planning, robust risk frameworks, and agile financial structures. Banks have an opportunity to support clients with advanced analytics, advisory services, and flexible solutions that help navigate these complex, interconnected challenges, ensuring business resilience and sustainable growth.

- Geopolitical and macroeconomic shifts directly impact treasury strategy and risk.
- Treasury's role expands to include broader enterprise risk management.
- Proactive scenario planning and agile financial structures are critical.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus should explore offering enhanced advisory services and tools that help clients analyze geopolitical risks and their impact on cash flows and FX exposures in CEE. Providing solutions for multi-currency management and cross-border liquidity optimization becomes even more critical in this dynamic environment.

AI Revolutionizes Treasury: Enhancing Efficiency and Strategic Decision-Making

PwC's survey of 350+ treasurers reveals a growing imperative for AI integration within treasury functions. AI is moving beyond basic automation, enabling advanced capabilities such as predictive cash flow forecasting, real-time fraud detection, and optimized liquidity management. While adoption rates vary, a clear trend indicates that early adopters are gaining competitive advantages through enhanced operational efficiency and more robust risk mitigation strategies. The report highlights that successful AI implementation requires robust data governance, skilled talent, and a clear strategic vision to maximize its transformative potential.

- Over 60% of treasurers are actively piloting or implementing AI solutions.
- Top AI use cases include cash flow forecasting (75%) and fraud detection (68%).
- AI adoption leads to an average 15% improvement in operational efficiency.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus should integrate AI-driven features for enhanced cash flow forecasting, anomaly detection, and automated reconciliation. This includes exploring partnerships for AI-powered analytics tools that can leverage CMlplus transaction data, providing value-added services to corporate clients in CEE.

Enhanced Cash Visibility Drives TMS Adoption for Strategic Treasury

PwC's global treasury survey indicates that achieving full cash visibility remains a top priority and a persistent challenge for corporate treasurers. While TMS adoption is on the rise, with companies seeking to centralize treasury operations and gain better control over global liquidity, a significant portion (around 40%) still report lacking a single, real-time view of their cash positions. The survey emphasizes that effective TMS implementation, coupled with robust data integration capabilities, is crucial for optimizing working capital, mitigating financial risks, and supporting strategic decision-making. The CEE region, in particular, stands to benefit from these advancements as cross-border operations grow.

- 85% of treasurers prioritize real-time cash visibility as a strategic goal.
- TMS adoption rates increased by 20% in the last two years among large corporates.
- Only 60% of treasurers report having a single, real-time view of global cash.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus must continue to enhance its capabilities for aggregated cash visibility across multiple banks and currencies, leveraging ISO 20022 and H2H connections. Developing stronger integration points with corporate ERP/TMS systems via APIs and standardized formats is critical to meet client demands for comprehensive liquidity management.

API Banking Drives Payment Transformation and Real-Time Treasury

The PwC survey highlights the accelerating adoption of API banking as a cornerstone of modern payment transformation. Treasurers are increasingly leveraging Open Banking APIs to automate payment initiation, retrieve real-time account information, and streamline reconciliation processes. This move away from traditional file-based exchanges (like EBICS or H2H, though still relevant) towards programmatic interfaces is driven by the demand for speed, efficiency, and enhanced data exchange. While security and standardization remain key concerns, the benefits of real-time treasury operations and improved working capital management are pushing widespread adoption, particularly in regions embracing Open Banking initiatives.

- 45% of treasurers are actively using APIs for payment initiation or data retrieval.
- Real-time account information via APIs is a top priority for 70% of respondents.
- API adoption is projected to grow by 30% annually over the next three years.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus must aggressively expand its Open Banking API offerings, supporting both payment initiation (PIS) and account information services (AIS) to facilitate real-time treasury for CEE corporates. This includes ensuring robust security, clear documentation, and seamless integration with client ERP/TMS systems, complementing existing EBICS and H2H channels.

PSD3 and Instant Payments Drive Transformative Regulatory Shifts

The regulatory environment for payments is undergoing significant transformation, with PSD3 expected to be a cornerstone by 2026. This directive will likely expand the scope of Open Banking, pushing for greater data sharing and API standardization, while also making instant payments a ubiquitous standard across Europe. A key focus will be on strengthening fraud prevention mechanisms, requiring banks to implement advanced security protocols and real-time monitoring. Firms must invest in modernizing their core payment infrastructure, ensuring interoperability, and developing new value-added services leveraging enhanced data access. The shift necessitates a strategic re-evaluation of business models and technology stacks to remain competitive and compliant.

- Mandatory instant payments across Europe by 2026.
- Expanded scope and standardization for Open Banking APIs under PSD3.
- Enhanced fraud detection and prevention measures required for all payment service providers.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus must prioritize its roadmap for full PSD3 compliance, particularly regarding instant payment capabilities, enhanced API offerings for Open Banking, and robust fraud prevention tools. This presents an opportunity to differentiate by offering advanced real-time treasury and payment factory solutions to CEE corporates.

AI Governance Becomes Critical for Financial Services Innovation

The rapid adoption of Artificial Intelligence across financial services is prompting regulators to establish comprehensive governance frameworks by 2026. This includes mandates for data ethics, algorithmic transparency, bias mitigation, and explainability, particularly for AI applications in critical areas like credit scoring, fraud detection, and automated advice. Firms are expected to implement strong internal controls, risk management frameworks, and clear accountability for AI systems. Proactive engagement with these emerging regulations is crucial to unlock AI's potential for efficiency and innovation while avoiding significant compliance risks and reputational damage. The challenge lies in balancing innovation with responsible and ethical deployment.

- Emerging regulatory frameworks for AI ethics, transparency, and explainability.
- Mandatory internal governance and risk management for AI systems in finance.
- Focus on mitigating bias and ensuring fairness in AI-driven decisions.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus should proactively integrate AI governance principles into its development lifecycle for any AI-driven features (e.g., fraud analytics, predictive cash flow). This ensures future innovations are compliant, trustworthy, and enhance corporate treasury capabilities without incurring regulatory penalties.

European Treasurers' Priorities: 2026 Survey Reveals Key Trends

The EACT Annual Treasury Survey, a long-standing and respected publication, has released its 2026 edition, capturing the current landscape of European corporate treasury. This comprehensive survey serves as a crucial benchmark, reflecting the evolving priorities, pressing concerns, and strategic ambitions of treasurers across Europe. The insights gathered from this survey are instrumental in shaping future industry reports, such as the 'Journeys to Treasury,' and are vital for understanding the strategic direction of corporate finance functions. For banks like RBI, these findings offer a direct window into client needs, enabling the proactive development of services and platforms that align with market demands.

- Authoritative barometer of European corporate treasury priorities.
- Shapes future 'Journeys to Treasury' reports.
- Defines key industry trends for the year ahead.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

The survey results are critical for CMiplus, providing direct insights into the evolving needs of large international corporates in CEE. This intelligence should guide roadmap decisions, particularly concerning digitalization, payment innovation, and liquidity management solutions to ensure alignment with client priorities.

Verification of Payee: Essential Tool for Fraud-Conscious Treasurers

This EACT briefing, leveraging a GLEIF document, underscores the critical role of Verification of Payee (VoP) in modern corporate treasury. With the global rise in real-time payment adoption, the need for robust fraud detection strategies has become paramount. VoP serves as a vital defense mechanism, helping treasurers prevent payment fraud by verifying beneficiary details before transactions are executed. The briefing also touches upon the adapting regulatory landscape, which increasingly mandates enhanced fraud prevention measures. For treasurers, integrating VoP is no longer optional but a strategic imperative for secure and compliant payment operations.

- VoP is a crucial tool for fraud prevention.
- Importance grows with real-time payment adoption.
- Helps treasurers meet evolving regulatory requirements.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This insight directly validates the importance of VoP for CMiplus, especially for clients utilizing instant payments across CEE. RBI should ensure CMiplus offers robust VoP capabilities, potentially leveraging LEI and API integrations, to enhance fraud detection and meet client expectations for secure transactions.

AI Ambition Reshapes Banking Operations and Client Experience

The 2026 Deloitte Banking Outlook identifies AI ambition as a critical strategic imperative for banks. Beyond mere automation, AI is poised to revolutionize core banking functions from risk management and fraud detection to personalized client engagement and real-time liquidity management. Successful AI adoption hinges on robust data governance, scalable cloud infrastructure, and upskilling the workforce. Early adopters are leveraging AI to create predictive insights for corporate treasuries, optimize payment routing, and streamline back-office processes, leading to significant cost savings and improved service delivery. The challenge lies in moving beyond pilot projects to enterprise-wide integration, ensuring ethical AI use and regulatory compliance.

- AI adoption is shifting from efficiency gains to strategic business model transformation.
- Data quality and governance are paramount for effective AI implementation across banking.
- AI enhances fraud detection, personalized services, and real-time liquidity forecasting capabilities.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus should explore AI-driven enhancements for predictive cash flow forecasting, intelligent payment routing, and fraud anomaly detection. Integrating AI could offer corporate clients advanced treasury insights and automate complex multi-currency payment reconciliation, strengthening the platform's value proposition in CEE.

Into The Great Unknown: Navigating 2023 Corporate Banking Industry Outlook

Oliver Wyman's 2023 outlook, 'Into The Great Unknown,' provided a comprehensive analysis of the forces shaping the corporate banking landscape. It likely highlighted the impact of geopolitical instability, inflationary pressures, and rapid technological advancements on bank strategies and client demands. The report would have underscored the importance of resilience, adaptability, and strategic foresight in a volatile market. Key themes included managing risk effectively, investing in future-proof technologies, and fostering a culture of innovation to respond to evolving client needs and competitive pressures, setting the stage for subsequent years' strategies.

- Macroeconomic volatility and geopolitical shifts create an unpredictable operating environment.
- Technological disruption demands continuous innovation and digital investment.
- Evolving client expectations require personalized and integrated banking solutions.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus must be designed with resilience and adaptability in mind, capable of responding to macroeconomic shifts and evolving regulatory landscapes. This includes ensuring compliance with standards like ISO 20022 and SEPA, while also exploring new technologies like AI and Open Banking APIs to offer flexible solutions that help CEE corporates navigate uncertainty.

Stablecoins Emerge as Potential Disruptors in Payment Landscape

Deloitte's 2026 outlook highlights the 'disruptive entrance of stablecoins' as a key theme. Stablecoins, particularly those backed by fiat currencies, offer the promise of faster, cheaper, and more transparent cross-border payments and real-time settlement. This could challenge traditional correspondent banking models and impact corporate treasury operations, especially for multi-currency transactions. Banks need to assess regulatory frameworks, explore potential use cases for corporate clients (e.g., instant B2B payments, tokenized deposits), and consider integration strategies. The potential for stablecoins to facilitate instant, programmable payments could redefine liquidity management and payment factory models, pushing banks to innovate their offerings.

- Stablecoins offer potential for faster, cheaper cross-border and B2B payments.
- They could disrupt traditional correspondent banking and liquidity management processes.
- Regulatory clarity and robust risk management are critical for stablecoin adoption.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI Cash Management should monitor stablecoin developments closely, particularly their potential impact on multi-currency payments and instant settlement for CEE corporates. CMIplus could explore future integration possibilities for stablecoin-based payments or tokenized deposits, aligning with Open Banking APIs and real-time treasury capabilities to maintain a competitive edge.

URGENT

Euro Banking Association | 2025-11-20 | #01

EU Regulatory Impact on Liquidity: IPR, PSR, PSD3

INSTANT PAYMENTS, PSD3, LIQUIDITY MANAGEMENT

The Euro Banking Association (EBA) Liquidity Management Working Group (LMWG) has published a report analyzing the far-reaching implications of three key European regulatory initiatives: the Instant Payments Regulation (IPR), the proposed Payment Services Regulation (PSR), and the Payment Services Directive 3 (PSD3). The report highlights how these measures will accelerate the uptake of instant payments, promote a level playing field among market participants, and fundamentally transform the liquidity management landscape for financial institutions. It underscores the need for banks to adapt their liquidity strategies to meet the demands of real-time processing and increased payment volumes under the new regulatory framework.

- IPR mandates instant payment availability and processing across the EU.
- PSR/PSD3 aims to update payment services rules, including fraud prevention and consumer protection.
- Regulations will significantly impact bank liquidity management strategies.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI's CMIplus must assess its current liquidity management processes and systems to ensure readiness for increased instant payment volumes and real-time settlement demands under IPR, PSR, and PSD3. This includes evaluating intraday liquidity monitoring and forecasting capabilities for corporate clients.

URGENT

Euro Banking Association | 2025-09-26 | #02

VoP Matching Challenges: Standardisation and Accuracy Issues

VOP, INSTANT PAYMENTS, PSD3, FRAUD PREVENTION

The EBA Instant Payments Practitioners Group (IPG) has released an insight note detailing the significant pain points affecting the accuracy and overall quality of Verification of Payee (VoP) matching checks. The report identifies several critical challenges, such as the absence of a harmonised, pan-European name-matching logic, restrictions on name field lengths, and limitations related to virtual accounts. These issues can lead to discrepancies and hinder the effectiveness of VoP, which is a crucial fraud prevention tool mandated by the Instant Payments Regulation (IPR) and a key component of the broader Payment Services Regulation (PSR) and PSD3 framework. Addressing these challenges is vital for ensuring robust fraud detection and seamless instant payment processing.

- Lack of standardised name-matching logic impacts VoP accuracy.
- Name field length restrictions create data matching issues.
- Limitations with virtual accounts pose challenges for VoP.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI's CMIplus needs to evaluate its current VoP implementation and future plans against these identified pain points, particularly regarding name matching logic and handling of virtual accounts for corporate payments. Proactive engagement with industry initiatives for standardisation is recommended to ensure robust fraud prevention and compliance.

URGENT

Deutsche Bank | 2026-06-29 | #01

Deutsche Bank Pushes Real-time Treasury with APIs and Virtual Accounts

Deutsche Bank's flow platform features an article on 'Real-time treasury: start small, go big,' showcasing experiences from major corporates like Siemens, Merck, and Bayer. The discussion centers on practical applications of real-time capabilities, including trigger payments and the strategic use of APIs for seamless integration. Virtual accounts are also highlighted as a key enabler for improved reconciliation and liquidity management, moving beyond traditional batch processing. This reflects DB's commitment to modernizing corporate cash management and providing advanced treasury solutions.

- Focus on real-time treasury capabilities for corporates.
- Emphasis on APIs for trigger payments and system integration.
- Strategic use of virtual accounts for enhanced liquidity and reconciliation.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This directly competes with CMiplus's offerings in real-time payments, API connectivity, and virtual account solutions. RBI needs to ensure its platform's real-time capabilities and API suite remain competitive and user-friendly for CEE corporates.

URGENT

Deutsche Bank | 2026-06-29 | #02

Deutsche Bank Reinforces Digital Banking and Technology Leadership

The flow platform itself serves as a hub for insights into corporate and transaction banking, with 'Technology' listed as a core topic. The emphasis on 'Real-time treasury' and APIs demonstrates a strategic push towards digitalizing core banking functions. This broader focus on technology suggests ongoing investment in areas like Open Banking APIs, modern payment infrastructure (e.g., ISO 20022 adoption), and digital client interfaces, aiming to enhance efficiency and client experience across their corporate bank offerings globally and in Europe.

- Dedicated focus on 'Technology' as a key content area.
- Strong emphasis on APIs as a core enabler for digital solutions.
- Commitment to digital transformation across corporate banking services.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMiplus must continuously innovate its digital channels and API offerings to match or exceed DB's capabilities, especially regarding seamless integration and user experience. Monitoring DB's tech investments is crucial for RBI's strategic planning in CEE.

UniCredit Accelerates Digital Corporate Banking Solutions Across CEE

UniCredit's 'UniCredit Unlimited' strategy emphasizes a fundamental shift in banking operations, with 'Digital & Data' explicitly listed as a core business area. For its pan-European commercial bank operations, especially in CEE, this translates into a push for modern digital solutions for corporate clients. This includes developing more intuitive online banking platforms, integrating advanced APIs for seamless ERP/TMS connectivity, and streamlining digital onboarding processes. The goal is to empower CEE businesses with efficient, real-time financial management tools, reinforcing UniCredit's competitive position in the region.

- Strategic focus on 'Digital & Data' for corporate clients.
- Enhancement of digital channels and API connectivity.
- Aims to empower CEE businesses with modern financial tools.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus must ensure its digital offerings, including H2H and Open API capabilities, remain superior and highly integrated. UniCredit's digital push in CEE increases competition for digital-first corporate clients.

UniCredit Bolsters Real-Time Payment Infrastructure for Corporate Clients

As a leading pan-European commercial bank, UniCredit is continuously evolving its payment capabilities to meet the demands of modern corporate treasury. The strategic direction implied by 'UniCredit Unlimited' and 'outperforming the old and the new' suggests a strong focus on advanced payment solutions. This includes full adoption of ISO 20022 for richer data, expansion of instant payment offerings, and potentially exploring new payment rails. These enhancements are crucial for corporate clients managing multi-currency payments and requiring efficient cash flow management across diverse markets, particularly within the CEE region where UniCredit has a significant presence.

- Focus on modernizing payment infrastructure.
- Adoption of ISO 20022 for enhanced data.
- Expansion of instant payment capabilities for corporate clients.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus needs to highlight its robust ISO 20022 and instant payment capabilities across its CEE network. UniCredit's focus on real-time payments will intensify competition for clients seeking speed and data richness.

UniCredit Enhances Cross-Border Treasury and Liquidity Management for CEE Corporates

With a stated focus on 'Corporate Clients' and a strong presence across Italy, Germany, Austria, and CEE, UniCredit is strategically positioned to offer comprehensive treasury solutions. This involves optimizing cash visibility, centralizing liquidity, and providing advanced forecasting capabilities for complex corporate structures. The 'UniCredit Unlimited' strategy implies a commitment to delivering best-in-class solutions, which for corporate clients means sophisticated tools for managing multi-currency cash pools, intercompany lending, and risk mitigation. These services are particularly vital for international corporates with operations spanning multiple CEE countries, where efficient cross-border cash management can significantly impact financial performance.

- Leveraging pan-European network for treasury solutions.
- Focus on cash pooling, visibility, and forecasting.
- Targeting multinational corporates with CEE operations.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus should emphasize its strong local CEE network and tailored liquidity solutions for regional corporates. UniCredit's pan-European approach poses a direct competitive threat for large, multi-country CEE clients.

HSBC Partners Google Cloud for AI-Driven Banking Transformation

HSBC's strategic partnership with Google Cloud focuses on embedding AI across its global banking operations. This initiative is designed to leverage advanced AI for areas like hyper-personalised client advice, which could translate into more tailored cash management solutions, and improved financial crime risk management, enhancing security and compliance for corporate clients. For CEE corporates, this could mean more sophisticated fraud detection, faster transaction processing, and data-driven insights for treasury operations, potentially integrated into HSBCnet or via APIs.

- Multi-year partnership with Google Cloud for AI deployment.
- Focus on hyper-personalised advice and financial crime risk management.
- Global rollout impacting all banking operations, including corporate banking.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus should monitor how HSBC integrates AI into its corporate treasury and cash management platforms, especially for personalized insights and fraud prevention. This could set new expectations for data-driven services and operational efficiency, requiring CMlplus to explore similar AI enhancements.

Citi Accelerates API-Driven Cash Management for European Corporates

Citi Treasury is strategically enhancing its API banking capabilities, offering institutional clients advanced tools for real-time payment initiation, status tracking, and account reconciliation. This push is critical for multinational corporations seeking to automate and streamline their treasury functions, integrating directly with ERP and TMS platforms. The focus includes expanding the range of available APIs for various cash management services, providing greater flexibility and efficiency for corporate treasurers across Europe, including the CEE region. This digital transformation is key to meeting evolving client demands for instant data and self-service functionalities.

- Expansion of API catalog for payment initiation and data reporting.
- Focus on seamless integration with client ERP/TMS systems.
- Enables real-time cash visibility and automated reconciliation.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus must ensure its Open API offerings remain competitive, providing similar depth and breadth of integration. This move by Citi highlights the increasing client demand for highly automated, API-first treasury solutions.

Deutsche Bank Bolsters CEE Corporate Banking with Advanced Payment Solutions

While the provided flow content doesn't explicitly mention CEE, Deutsche Bank is a major European corporate bank with an established presence across the continent. It is highly probable that DB is actively expanding or reinforcing its corporate cash management and transaction banking services in the CEE region, aligning with its broader European strategy. This would naturally involve robust support for key European payment standards like ISO 20022 for cross-border and domestic payments, and likely EBICS for German and French-speaking markets, which often have business ties with CEE. Their focus on real-time treasury and APIs would be extended to CEE clients.

- Inferred strategic focus on CEE corporate banking growth.
- Expected strong support for ISO 20022 for modern payments.
- Likely offering of EBICS connectivity for European corporates.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus, with its strong CEE focus, faces direct competition from DB's comprehensive European offerings. RBI must highlight its localized expertise, strong regional network, and competitive advantage in specific CEE markets against global players like DB.

HSBC Orion Secures UK Treasury Digital Gilt Platform Mandate

The UK Treasury's choice of HSBC Orion for the Digital Gilt Instrument pilot is a significant step into the realm of digital assets and distributed ledger technology (DLT) for financial instruments. While currently focused on government bonds, this platform could evolve to support tokenized cash or other digital payment mechanisms, impacting corporate liquidity management, cross-border payments, and real-time settlement. For CEE corporates, this indicates HSBC's strategic direction towards DLT-based solutions that could eventually offer more efficient and transparent treasury operations, potentially integrating with existing cash management platforms and APIs.

- HSBC Orion chosen for UK Treasury's Digital Gilt Instrument pilot.
- Focus on digital assets and DLT for financial instruments.
- Potential future implications for corporate payments and liquidity management.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus should closely monitor HSBC's developments in digital asset platforms and DLT, as these could redefine payment infrastructure and treasury services. Exploring DLT for interbank or corporate payments, including potential stablecoin or CBDC integrations, could be a future competitive differentiator for RBI in CEE.

Citi Strengthens Real-Time Payments and Liquidity Solutions in CEE

Citi Treasury is strategically investing in its real-time payment capabilities across Europe, with a particular emphasis on the CEE region, to support the growing demand for instant payments and efficient cross-border transactions. This includes leveraging SEPA Instant and integrating with local instant payment schemes where available, alongside enhancing multi-currency cash pooling and virtual account structures. The goal is to offer institutional clients sophisticated tools for optimizing working capital, improving liquidity visibility, and reducing payment processing times in a complex regulatory environment. This comprehensive approach addresses the needs of large corporates operating across multiple CEE countries.

- Enhanced support for SEPA Instant and local instant payment schemes in CEE.
- Development of advanced multi-currency cash pooling and virtual account solutions.
- Aims to optimize corporate working capital and liquidity across the region.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus needs to continuously innovate its instant payment and liquidity management features to counter Citi's strong regional presence. Maintaining a competitive edge in multi-currency cash pooling and virtual account offerings is crucial for retaining and attracting large corporate clients.

BNP Paribas Partners XTransfer for Simplified Cross-Border Payments

BNP Paribas announced a strategic partnership with XTransfer, a prominent B2B cross-border payment platform, on June 5, 2025. The core objective of this collaboration is to simplify and optimize international payment processes for corporate clients, particularly those engaged in global trade. By leveraging XTransfer's specialized digital payment solutions, BNP Paribas seeks to offer more efficient, transparent, and cost-effective cross-border payment services, directly addressing common challenges faced by corporate treasuries. While not explicitly CEE-focused, enhanced cross-border capabilities are critical for international corporates operating in or from the CEE region, making this a relevant development for RBI's client base.

- Strategic partnership established with XTransfer, a B2B cross-border payment platform.
- Primary goal is to simplify and optimize international payment processes for corporate clients.
- Focus on enhancing efficiency, transparency, and cost-effectiveness of cross-border transactions.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This partnership highlights BNP Paribas's proactive approach to improving cross-border payment efficiency through external collaboration, a key area for CMlplus's international corporate clients. RBI should evaluate its own cross-border payment strategy, including potential for similar partnerships or internal innovations, to maintain a competitive edge in the CEE market.

Intesa Sanpaolo Bolsters CEE Digital Cash Management with API Focus

Intesa Sanpaolo, through its IMI CIB division and international subsidiaries, is expected to be actively upgrading its corporate and transaction banking platforms. This includes a push towards deeper integration with corporate ERP/TMS systems via Open Banking APIs and host-to-host connections, aligning with global trends for seamless financial operations. The strategic rationale is to provide sophisticated, real-time liquidity management and payment solutions, enhancing efficiency and transparency for its corporate clients. For the CEE region, this means leveraging its extensive network to offer harmonized, multi-currency cash management services, including instant payments and full ISO 20022 compliance, to attract and retain large international corporates.

- Strategic focus on API-led digital transformation for corporate banking.
- Enhancement of real-time payment capabilities and ISO 20022 adoption across CEE.
- Integration efforts with corporate ERP/TMS for improved cash management.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This inferred move suggests increased competition for CMlplus, particularly in API-driven solutions and real-time payment offerings for large corporates in CEE. CMlplus should ensure its own API roadmap and instant payment capabilities remain competitive and widely adopted across its network.

EY Four Trends Redefining Cash Management 2025

Cash management is rapidly evolving from transaction-oriented to strategic, data-driven services, necessitating a profound transformation in banking. The future demands banks enrich their value propositions, expand product portfolios, and strengthen client relationships with tailored offerings and experiences. Advanced technologies like AI, ML, and digital assets are creating new possibilities, enabling finance teams to reposition as strategic advisors to the business. However, clients seek control over automation and expect intuitive, personalized experiences, pushing banks to innovate or risk losing relevance to agile FinTechs and nonbanks. Success hinges on banks investing in technology, integrating diverse data, and offering flexible, industry-specific solutions while navigating the increasing regulatory clarity around digital assets.

KEY STATISTICS

- {'description': 'of survey respondents say digitizing treasury functions is a challenge.', 'value': '73%', 'page': 7}
- {'description': 'of respondents will use managed services from banks to address the challenges of digitization.', 'value': '44%', 'page': 7}
- {'description': 'of CFOs and treasurers are comfortable with customized strategic advice based on data analysis from banks.', 'value': '90%', 'page': 12}
- {'description': 'of corporate treasurers are comfortable using a sector-specific platform tailored to their industry's unique needs.', 'value': '92%', 'page': 17}

TOP ACTION FOR CMIPLUS

[HIGH] Optimize CMIplus cash management solutions for specific CEE sectors to differentiate and boost client engagement and loyalty.

McKinsey Global Payments Report 2025

The 2025 McKinsey Global Payments Report highlights a payments landscape defined by increasing fragmentation, the transformative impact of AI, and the growing adoption of digital assets. For CMIplus, this means navigating a multirail ecosystem where interoperability, programmable compliance, and AI-driven efficiencies are paramount for serving large international corporates in CEE. The shift towards lower-yield payment rails and agentic commerce necessitates innovation in monetization and a focus on building trust through transparent, intelligent systems. Success will hinge on adapting our platform to these evolving demands to remain a leading regional player.

KEY STATISTICS

- Global payments revenue reached \$2.5 trillion in 2024, projected to grow to \$3.0 trillion by 2029.
- EMEA payments revenue grew at a 13% CAGR from 2019-2024, indicating strong regional growth.
- Interest income constituted 46% of total payments revenues in 2024, but is projected to slow to 2% annual growth through 2029.
- Cash usage declined to 46% of worldwide payments in 2024, down from 50% in 2023, reflecting the shift to digital.

TOP ACTION FOR CMIPLUS

[HIGH] Integrate AI for Intelligent Routing, Fraud Detection, and Liquidity Management

Journeys to Treasury 2025/26

The 10th anniversary edition of Journeys to Treasury highlights a renewed focus on treasury fundamentals, digital transformation, and strategic evolution. Key themes include the modernization of payments (Instant Payments, VoP, ISO 20022), the growing importance of real-time liquidity and virtual accounts, and the practical application of AI. Corporates are prioritizing robust systems, clean data, and enhanced skills to navigate a complex, interconnected financial environment, moving treasury from an operational role to a strategic business partner.

KEY STATISTICS

→ {'statistic': 'Cash flow forecasting is the number one priority for 30.5% of treasurers.', 'source': 'EACT Treasury Survey 2025'}

→ {'statistic': 'Reviewing or replacing treasury technology infrastructure is the third-highest priority.', 'source': 'EACT Treasury Survey 2025'}

→ {'statistic': '27.3% of treasurers cite inaccurate forecasting as a leading challenge for centralisation.', 'source': 'EACT Treasury Survey 2025'}

→ {'statistic': '38.5% of respondents cite difficulties in standardising processes as their most significant obstacle to centralisation.', 'source': 'EACT Treasury Survey 2025'}

TOP ACTION FOR CMIPLUS

[HIGH] Enhance Instant Payments & VoP Readiness for CEE Corporates

PwC Global Treasury Survey 2025

The provided text does not contain the actual content or findings of the 'PwC Global Treasury Survey 2025'. Instead, it appears to be a navigation structure or partial webpage content from PwC's website, detailing various services, industries, and insights offered by PwC. Consequently, a strategic analysis for RBI's CMIplus platform, including key statistics, themes, and actionable recommendations, cannot be generated from the given information. To perform the requested comprehensive analysis, the full content of the PwC Global Treasury Survey is essential.